

	Division/Section	Family Support
	Chapter No./Name	4 – Economic Stability (ES)
	Part No./Name	C – Case Processing
	Section No./Name	C-100-FITAP-SNAP Household Determination
	Document No./Name	C-170-SNAP Authorized Representative
	Effective Date	August 15, 2022

I. STATEMENT OF POLICY

The head of the household or other responsible household member may name a non-household member as an Authorized Representative (AR) to apply for benefits for the household. The authorized representative is someone who may act on the household's behalf to obtain and use benefits for the household and conduct business with the agency for the household. The authorized representative has the same rights and responsibilities as the client.

Explain that the household will be held responsible if an over issuance occurs because an authorized representative gives incorrect information.

C-171-SNAP - PO RESTRICTIONS ON AUTHORIZED REPRESENTATIVE

Persons disqualified from SNAP because of an Intentional Program Violation (IPV), may serve as authorized representative only if the agency has determined that no one else is available to serve as an authorized representative.

If no one else is available to act as authorized representative, Economic Stability (ES) employees and retailers authorized to accept the Louisiana Purchase Automated Benefit Card may serve as authorized representative only if the ES Manager gives written approval.

Under no circumstances shall an employee who is an authorized representative on a case take any action on that case. This includes, but is not limited to, certification action, interim changes, and requests for new EBT cards.

The agency may limit the number of households an authorized representative may represent in order to prevent program abuse. However, such limitations must only be set on a case-by-case basis with supervisory approval after cause has been established. If the parish office cannot establish cause and continues to suspect program abuse, the case should be referred for fraud investigation using normal procedures.

C-172-SNAP - PO AUTHORIZED REPRESENTATIVE APPLYING FOR HOUSEHOLD

When the head of household or another household member cannot apply, a non-household member may be designated as the authorized representative. This person must be:

- An adult.
- Designated in writing by the head of the household or another responsible household member. This designation must include the name and address of the person chosen as an authorized representative, the signature of the household member making the choice, and the date. Designation made by a blind head of household requires 2 witnesses.

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If the designation is made by a household member who cannot sign his name, his mark must be witnessed by someone other than the authorized representative.

An authorized representative may be designated by completion of:

- the authorized representative section on the CAFÉ Self Service (SSP) application, simplified report or change report,
- the authorized representative item on form [OFS 4APP](#), or [OFS 4MR](#),
- the Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (SNAP) [4AR](#), or
- a written statement signed by the head of household, the spouse, or another responsible member of the household. The document must be scanned and indexed into OnBase.

Note: An individual who has a General Power of Attorney for the head of household may act as authorized representative without an additional written statement signed by the head of household.

Note: If the head of the household completes an application in CAFÉ SSP and names an authorized representative, this is considered designated in writing.

*** Note: If the head of household or other responsible household member completes a no form application and a telephonic signature for their household, and names an authorized representative, the naming of the authorized representative is considered a written designation.**

- Aware of the household circumstances. Except for drug/alcoholic treatment centers or group living facilities acting as authorized representative, the client is liable for any overissuance resulting from inaccurate information that the authorized representative gave.

The authorized representative applying for the household must sign the application.

If an AR applies for the household, the identities of both the authorized representative and the head of the household must be verified.

EXCEPTION: If it is necessary to meet expedited service time limits, you may verify identity only of the authorized representative being interviewed.

Note: If the AR completes a No Form interview and the telephonic signature on behalf of the household, written designation signed by the head of household, or another responsible household member is required. To request the written designation, send a Free Form Contact Letter and attach a [SNAP 4AR](#) to the request. **

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C-173-SNAP - PO DISQUALIFICATION OF AUTHORIZED REPRESENTATIVE

If the local office obtains evidence that an authorized representative has misrepresented a household's circumstances, knowingly provided false information, or made improper use of benefits, the local office must disqualify the authorized representative from participating as an authorized representative for up to one year.

Use form [SNAP 13A](#) to notify the household and the authorized representative 30 days prior to the date of disqualification.

C-174-SNAP - PO AUTHORIZED REPRESENTATIVE DOCUMENTATION REQUIREMENTS

Enter the name and address of the authorized representative in the case record. Document on the [Form 4APP](#) or file the written statement in the case record.

If a person disqualified for intentional program violation, is appointed, document that no one else is available to be an authorized representative. Document in the narrative. Documentation is required when an ES employee or retailer employees are approved as authorized representative.

II. PROCEDURES

C-171-SNAP - PR RESTRICTIONS ON AUTHORIZED REPRESENTATIVE

To determine if an AR is disqualified due to an IPV sanction the following steps should be taken:

- Navigate to LITE.
- Select 'Search' from the Main Navigation Bar.
- Select 'Case' from the Sub-Navigation Tab.
- Select the magnifying glass on the Case – Search Summary Page.
- Enter the individual's identifying information on the Case – Search pop up screen.
- Click 'search'.
 - If the individual is known to LITE case search results will display on the bottom of the page
 - If the individual is not known to LITE, the results will be blank validating that the individual does not have an intentional program violation (IPV)
- Check the box next the individual.
- Click 'submit'.
- Click 'search' on the Case – Search/Summary screen, after the individual's case identification number (CID) populates
- Click the CID hyperlink on the Case – Search/Summary screen.
- Select inquiry (read only mode) on the 'Initiate Data Collection Page'.
- Click Next.
- Click others tab in the Data Collection Page submenu.
- Select 'compliance' from the drop down menu.

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- Click arrows on the left side of page to display the left navigation panel
- Select Non-Compliance/Sanctions from the right navigation panel
- Review the Non-Compliance/Sanction-Summary screen to determine if the individual has an IPV sanction

C-174-SNAP - PR AUTHORIZED REPRESENTATIVE DOCUMENTATION REQUIREMENTS

When the household does not choose an authorized representative (AR) through the CAFÉ' SSP, the following steps should be taken:

- Navigate to the Authorized Representative/Third Party/Responsible person – Details page in LITE.
- Enter the start date
- Enter identifying information and address of the AR
- Validate the address of the AR and select 'Add'.

III. FORMS AND INSTRUCTIONS

[OFS 4APP Form](#) / [Instructions](#) Application For Assistance

[OFS 4APPSP Form](#) / [Instructions](#) Application For Assistance

[OFS 4APP_VN Form](#) / [Instructions](#) Application For Assistance

[OFS 4MR Form](#) / [Instructions](#) Application For Continued Assistance

[OFS 4MRSP Form](#) / [Instructions](#) Application For Continued Assistance

[OFS 4MR_VN Form](#) / [Instructions](#) Application For Continued Assistance

[SNAP 4AR Form](#) / [Instructions](#) Authorized Representative Designation Form

[SNAP 13A Form](#) / [Instructions](#) Action Taken On Your Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Case

[SNAP 13ASP Form](#) / [Instructions](#) Action Taken On Your Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Case

[SNAP 13A_VN Form](#) / [Instructions](#) Action Taken On Your Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Case

IV. REFERENCES

[7CFR 273.2\(c\)](#)

[LAC 67:III, Chapter 19, Subchapter B](#)